

gymbro

Install Guide

Get the workout tracker onto your own iPhone —
written for complete beginners. Every click is spelled out.

Repository:

<https://github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro>

Free to install with any Apple ID · no programming knowledge needed

1. What is gymbro, and what are we about to do?

gymbro is a personal workout and nutrition tracker: log workouts from ready-made plans, snap photos of meals to count calories with AI, speak your sets out loud, and watch your strength grow on charts. Everything stays on your phone — no account, no cloud.

Because gymbro is not on the App Store, you install it yourself using a Mac. Don't worry if you have never done anything like this: this guide assumes zero experience and walks through every single click. The one-time setup takes about an hour (mostly waiting for downloads). After that, keeping the app running takes two minutes a week.

2. What you need

- **A Mac** (any reasonably recent MacBook or iMac).
- **Your iPhone** and its **charging cable** (it must connect to the Mac).
- **An Apple ID** — the normal, free one you already use for the App Store.
- **About 15 GB of free disk space** on the Mac (the Apple developer tools are big).
- About **an hour**, most of it waiting for downloads.

Note: You do NOT need: a paid developer account, programming knowledge, or an Android phone (this guide is iPhone-only).

3. Sixty seconds of background (worth reading)

3.1 What is "Terminal"?

Terminal is an app that comes with every Mac. Instead of clicking buttons, you type a line of text and press **Enter** (Return), and the Mac carries out that instruction. That's the whole idea. You type a line — exactly as written in this guide — press Enter, and wait until new text stops appearing and you see the blinking cursor again. Then you type the next line.

To open it: press **■ (Command) + Spacebar**, type **terminal**, press Enter.

3.2 What does "cd" mean?

Terminal is always "standing inside" one folder, and commands act on that folder. `cd` (change directory) is how you walk into a folder. So `cd ~/Desktop/gymbro-main` means: "go into the gymbro-main folder on my Desktop". A trick that avoids typos: type `cd` (with a space), then drag the folder from Finder into the Terminal window — the path fills itself in — then press Enter.

3.3 What are Xcode, Node, and the rest?

- **Xcode** — Apple's free app for building iPhone apps. We use it to sign and install gymbro.
- **Node.js** — a free program that runs the app's build tools.
- **Homebrew & CocoaPods** — two small helper tools the build needs. Installed with one pasted line each.

4. One-time: install the tools (≈45 min, mostly waiting)

4.1 Install Xcode

- 1 Open the **App Store** app on the Mac.
- 2 Search for **Xcode**, click **Get**, then **Install**. It is a very large download (often 30–60 minutes) — start it and move on to step 4.2 while it downloads.
- 3 When it finishes, **open Xcode once**. Click **Agree** on the licence, let it "install components" if it asks, then you can close it.

4.2 Install Node.js

- 1 In a web browser, go to **nodejs.org**.
- 2 Click the big green **LTS** download button (the version number doesn't matter).
- 3 Open the downloaded `.pkg` file and click **Continue** → **Continue** → **Agree** → **Install**. Enter your Mac password when asked.

4.3 Install Homebrew, then CocoaPods

Open Terminal (⌘+Space → "terminal" → Enter). Copy-paste this whole line, press Enter, type your Mac password when asked (the password stays invisible while you type — that's normal), and follow any "press RETURN to continue" prompts:

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"
```

When Homebrew finishes it may print a box saying **"Next steps"** with two commands to run — copy-paste those two lines too (they connect Homebrew to your Terminal). Then install CocoaPods:

```
brew install cocoapods
```

Note: If a command replies "command not found: brew", you skipped the "Next steps" lines above — scroll up in Terminal, find them, and run them. Then close Terminal, reopen it, and try again.

5. Get the app's code (2 minutes)

The easiest way — no extra tools needed:

- 1 In a browser, go to **<https://github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro>**.
- 2 Click the green <> **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**.
- 3 Open your **Downloads** folder and double-click `gymbro-main.zip` — it unzips into a folder called **gymbro-main**.
- 4 Drag the **gymbro-main** folder onto your **Desktop**.

Note: That folder IS the app. Don't rename it or move things around inside it. (If a techie friend set you up with "git clone" instead, your folder is called **gymbro**, not `gymbro-main` — use that name in the commands below.)

6. Prepare the project (10 minutes, two commands)

In Terminal, go into the app folder:

```
cd ~/Desktop/gymbro-main
```

Now run these two commands, **one at a time**, waiting for each to finish. The first downloads the app's building blocks (2–5 minutes, prints a lot of text — warnings are normal). The second generates the iPhone project (a few more minutes):

```
npm install
npx expo prebuild -p ios
```

You're done when the cursor is blinking again with no error in red. A new **ios** folder now exists inside gymbro-main.

7. Connect your Apple ID (5 minutes, one time)

Apple requires every iPhone app to be "signed" by someone. You'll sign it with your own free Apple ID. In Terminal:

```
open ios/gymbro.xcworkspace
```

Xcode opens. Then:

- 1 Menu bar → **Xcode** → **Settings** (or Preferences) → **Accounts** tab.
- 2 Click the **+** in the bottom-left → **Apple ID** → sign in. Close Settings.
- 3 In the left sidebar, click the blue **gymbro** icon at the very top.
- 4 In the middle of the window, click the **Signing & Capabilities** tab.
- 5 Tick **Automatically manage signing**, and under **Team** choose your own name ("Personal Team").
- 6 If a red error says the bundle identifier is "**not available**": click in the **Bundle Identifier** box just above and change it to something personal, e.g. `com.yourfirstname.gymbro`. The error disappears.

8. Put gymbro on your iPhone

8.1 Prepare the phone (one time)

- 1 Plug the iPhone into the Mac with the cable and **unlock it**.
- 2 If the phone shows "**Trust This Computer?**" → tap **Trust**, enter your passcode.
- 3 On the phone: **Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → scroll to the very bottom → **Developer Mode** → turn it **On** → the phone restarts → unlock it and confirm.

Note: Can't find Developer Mode? It sometimes only appears AFTER the first install attempt. Do step 8.2 once, let it fail, then check Settings again — it will be there.

8.2 Install

- 1 In Xcode, look at the toolbar at the top. Next to the play button there is a device menu — click it and choose **your iPhone** (it's listed by name, above the simulators).
- 2 Press the **■ (play) button** in the top-left.

- 3 The first build takes 5–10 minutes. When it finishes, **gymbro appears on your iPhone**.
- 4 First open only: if the phone says "**Untrusted Developer**" → on the phone go to **Settings** → **General** → **VPN & Device Management** → tap your Apple ID → **Trust**. Open the app again.

That's it. The app greets you with a short welcome tour, and small green cards explain each feature the first time you reach it.

9. The 7-day rule (read this!)

Apps signed with a free Apple ID stop opening after **7 days**. This is an Apple restriction, not a bug. When gymbro suddenly won't open:

- 1 Plug the iPhone into the Mac and unlock it.
- 2 Open Xcode (your project reopens via **File** → **Recent**), make sure your iPhone is selected in the device menu, and press **■** again.

Two minutes, and the app runs for another 7 days. **Your workouts, meals, and settings are never lost** — reinstalling on top keeps all data.

10. Optional: let everyone refresh it themselves with AltStore

Right now, only the Mac that has Xcode set up (yours, from sections 1–8) can refresh gymbro every 7 days. If friends installed it from your Mac too, they need **you** every week. **AltStore** fixes that: each friend does a short one-time setup on their own computer, and after that their phone refreshes itself automatically — forever, for free, with no Apple Developer Program and no more asking you.

Note: This does not remove Apple's 7-day rule — nothing free can, that's Apple's own policy. AltStore just automates *who* does the refreshing: instead of you doing it for everyone, each person's own computer does it for them.

10.1 What you need first: a shared .ipa file

AltStore installs a single file called an **.ipa** — think of it like the Android **.apk** from the other guide, but for iPhone. Someone who already has gymbro building in Xcode (section 8) needs to export this file **once** and share it (e.g. upload it to the project's GitHub Releases, or send it directly). See section 10.5 below for exactly how.

10.2 Part 1 — Each friend sets up AltStore (≈15 minutes, one time)

This needs a Windows or Mac computer — it does not have to be the same Mac used to build gymbro.

- 1 On the computer, go to **altstore.io** and download **AltServer** for Windows or Mac.
- 2 Mac: drag AltServer .app into the **Applications** folder, then open it — a small icon appears in the menu bar at the top of the screen. Windows: unzip the download, run **Setup.exe**, then also install **iTunes and iCloud from Apple's own website** (not the Microsoft Store) if not already installed — AltServer needs them to talk to the iPhone.
- 3 Plug the iPhone into that computer with a cable and **unlock it**. Tap **Trust** if asked.

- 4 Mac: open Finder, click the iPhone in the sidebar, tick "**Show this iPhone when on Wi-Fi**". Windows: open iTunes, sign in, and enable **Wi-Fi sync** for the device.
- 5 Click the AltServer icon (menu bar on Mac, system tray on Windows) → **Install AltStore** → choose the iPhone from the list.
- 6 A box appears asking for an Apple ID — type in your **own free Apple ID** (the normal one used for the App Store). This only goes to Apple, never anywhere else.
- 7 On the iPhone: **Settings** → **General** → **VPN & Device Management** → tap the new profile → **Trust**.
- 8 Still on the iPhone: **Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → scroll to the bottom → **Developer Mode** → turn it **On** → the phone restarts, unlock it and confirm.

AltStore is now on the phone — you'll see its icon like any other app.

10.3 Installing gymbro through AltStore

- 1 On the iPhone, get the `gymbro.ipa` file onto it — easiest way: open the link to it (e.g. from github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro/releases) in Safari and tap Download, or AirDrop it from another Apple device.
- 2 Open the **Files** app, find the downloaded .ipa, tap and hold it, and choose **Share** → **AltStore**. (If AltStore doesn't appear in the list, open AltStore first, go to the **My Apps** tab, tap + in the top-left, and browse to the file instead.)
- 3 AltStore installs it exactly like the Install step in section 8 — the same "Untrusted Developer" trust step appears if needed (Settings → General → VPN & Device Management → Trust).

10.4 Keeping it alive — no more asking anyone

AltStore automatically tries to refresh gymbro in the background whenever the phone is on the **same Wi-Fi network** as the computer running AltServer — so leave AltServer open (it can just sit in the menu bar / system tray) and it takes care of itself. To refresh right away instead: open AltStore, go to **My Apps**, and tap **Refresh All**.

Note: AltServer genuinely needs to be running on that computer for a refresh to work — the phone can't re-sign itself alone. If a week goes by with the computer never turned on, gymbro will still expire; just open AltServer, get on the same Wi-Fi as the phone, and refresh. Also: a free Apple ID can only keep **3 apps** signed at once on one device — if AltStore refuses to install, that limit is the usual reason.

10.5 Part 2 — Exporting the .ipa (for whoever already has gymbro in Xcode)

Once you've completed section 8 and gymbro runs on your own phone, you can export a shareable file for everyone else to sideload with AltStore:

- 1 In Xcode (open via `open ios/gymbro.xcworkspace` if it isn't already open), pick **Any iOS Device** from the device menu at the top — not your own phone this time.
- 2 Menu bar → **Product** → **Archive**. This takes a few minutes — it's building a release copy.
- 3 When it finishes, the **Organizer** window opens automatically with your archive selected. Click **Distribute App**.
- 4 Choose **Development** (the only option available with a free Apple ID) → **Next** through the remaining screens, leaving the defaults, until you reach **Export**.

- 5 Pick a folder to save into. Xcode creates a folder there containing `gymbro.ipa` — that's the file everyone else needs.
- 6 Share it: upload it to a **Release** on github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro (same place as the Android `.apk`), or send it directly via AirDrop, Drive, or email.

Note: This `.ipa` still "expires" 7 days from whenever it was exported — that's fine. AltStore resigns it fresh with each friend's own Apple ID the moment they install it, so the original export date doesn't matter to them.

11. Turn on the AI features (optional, free)

Photo food scanning and the nutrition coach use Google Gemini and need a free key:

- 1 On any device, go to aistudio.google.com/apikey, sign in with a Google account, click **Create API key**, and copy it.
- 2 In gymbro: **Home tab** → **Profile** → **AI features · Gemini key** → paste → **Save profile**.
- 3 The status line says **"Using your key"** — done. The key never leaves your phone.

12. Quick tour — what the app can do

- **Workouts tab** — start from a ready-made plan; your weights and reps from last time are pre-filled so you just try to beat them. Add/remove exercises mid-workout; a warm-up and cool-down checklist is generated for every session.
- **Guide me** — a coach mode that walks you through one set at a time with a rest timer.
- **Voice logging** — tap the mic and say "sixty by eight"; the set logs itself. Works offline, costs nothing.
- **Nutrition tab** — photograph your plate or scan a barcode; the AI counts calories and protein. Late-night meals ask whether they belong to yesterday or today.
- **Progress tab** — bodyweight, body fat %, and strength charts fill in automatically, with research-based insights (plateaus, volume spikes, neglected muscles).
- **Profile (Home tab)** — pick a training goal (it tunes plans and calorie targets), habit goals, and daily / long-term reminders with your own message.

Note: The app explains itself as you go: the first time you reach a feature, a small dismissible card describes it. It shows once and disappears after you use the feature or tap **X**.

13. When something goes wrong

13.1 Terminal says "command not found: npm" (or brew, or npx)

The tool from section 4 isn't installed or Terminal hasn't noticed it yet. Close Terminal completely (■Q), reopen it, try again. Still failing → redo the relevant part of section 4.

13.2 Terminal says "permission denied" or "no such file or directory"

Almost always a path problem. Use the drag-trick: type `cd` (with a space), drag the gymbro-main folder from Finder into the Terminal window, press Enter. Never run a folder path on its own without

cd in front.

13.3 Xcode: "bundle identifier not available" / signing errors

Section 7, last step — change the Bundle Identifier to `com.yourname.gymbro` and re-pick your Team.

13.4 Xcode can't see my iPhone

- Unlock the phone and keep it unlocked; check the cable is properly in.
- Tap **Trust** if the phone asks (again — iOS updates re-ask).
- Check **Developer Mode** is On (section 8.1) — iOS updates sometimes switch it off.
- Still nothing → unplug, replug, wait 30 seconds.

13.5 The app icon suddenly does nothing

The 7-day signature expired — completely normal. Section 9 (or 10.4 if you're on AltStore). Your data is safe.

13.6 "Untrusted Developer" when opening the app

Phone → Settings → General → VPN & Device Management → your Apple ID → Trust.

13.7 AI says a key is missing

Section 11 — add your free Gemini key in Profile.

13.8 AltStore won't install gymbro, or "maximum app limit reached"

- A free Apple ID can only keep **3 apps** signed at once per device — remove another sideloaded app in AltStore's My Apps tab, or use a different Apple ID.
- Make sure **AltServer** is actually running on the computer and both devices are on the same Wi-Fi network — AltStore can't sign anything without it.
- Re-do the Trust step: Settings → General → VPN & Device Management → your Apple ID → Trust.

14. Where to get help

- Open an issue at github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro/issues — describe what you clicked and copy the exact error text.
- Google AI Studio (free Gemini keys) — aistudio.google.com
- AltStore setup problems — faq.altstore.io
- Developers who want to modify the app: it's a standard Expo / React Native project — see the README at github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro.

This PDF is generated from `scripts/make_setup_pdf.py` — edit that file and re-run it to update the guide.